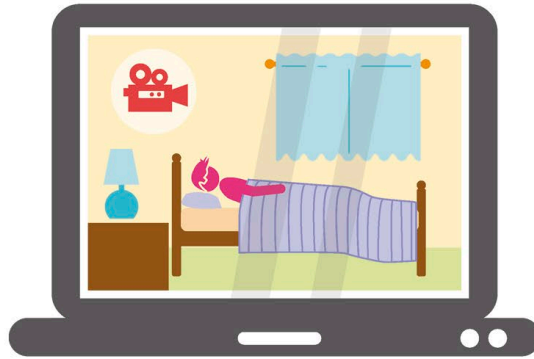


Webcams

Webcams are fantastic for video-calling friends and family, but there are also risks. A hacker can gain access to a computer through many different means. They might gain information from the computer's user or install malware that gives them access without a password. Once a hacker has done this, they can control the webcam and take images whenever they choose without the owner knowing. And it isn't just hackers that teens need to be wary of. Anyone can record a private video chat, which can later be shared online.

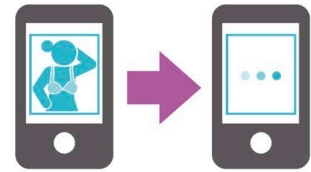
▷ Reduce the risk

It's critical to install firewalls and antivirus software to protect webcams from hacking.



Sexting

Sexting is when a person sends an image of themselves nude, partially nude, or in a sexually explicit pose to someone else. It comes with many risks, even if the sender and recipient are in a healthy relationship. If the relationship ends, or if a phone falls into the wrong hands, sexts can quickly be shared with a wide network of people. It's also illegal in some states if the person in the image and/or the person receiving it are under the age of 18 years old.



△ Always risky

Once a sext has been sent, the sender can no longer control who is able to see the image.

Stranger danger

As social media reflects elements of a person's real life, so, too, the potential dangers of sharing information with a stranger can affect a person's real life, even from a single online exchange. It is important that teens are cautious about revealing any information to any strangers who may go on to make contact and seek them out in person.

▽ Being aware

Tweens and teens should never share photos or videos online without their parents being aware.



ALERT!

Grooming

Grooming is when a person seeks to gain the trust of a child or teen with the intention of sexually exploiting or blackmailing them once embarrassing photographs or videos have been obtained. Online grooming allows the groomer to pretend to be someone that they're not in order to earn trust.

If a young person is being groomed, their behavior may change. Signs may include:

- being guarded about what they are doing online and being secretive about who they are speaking to
- wanting to spend more time online
- having new and expensive things that they're unable to explain
- having an older boyfriend or girlfriend. Many teens don't realize that they've been groomed, and believe the groomer to be a true boyfriend or girlfriend.

To reduce the risk of grooming, teens should always block strangers online and refuse to share any information or pictures. If a person suspects anything, it's best to talk it over, save any evidence, and report it to the police.